

The IoT policy by the government of India

The IoT policy document drafted by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) includes the following objectives:

- To create an IoT industry in India with a turnover of US\$ 15 billion by 2020. Presumably, India would have a share of 5-6 per cent of the global IoT market.
- To undertake capacity development (human and technology) for IoT-specific skillsets for domestic and international markets.
- To undertake research and development on all the assisting technologies.
- To develop IoT products specific to Indian needs in the domains of agriculture, health, water quality, natural disasters, transportation, security, automobiles, supply chain management, smart cities, automated metering and monitoring of utilities, waste management, as well as oil and gas.

It has been proposed that the framework of the IoT policy will be implemented via a multi-pillar approach. This comprises five vertical pillars, namely, demonstration centres, capacity building and incubation, R&D and innovation, incentives and engagements, human resource development, and two horizontal supports in the form of standards and the governance structure.

To me, the government's initiatives towards IoT are not only exciting but also a strong signal to us to join hands and work to our utmost capacity to make the IoT dream come true.

Q Last of all, where do you see the app market in the next five years? Will it be all-pervasive in India?

The app market is presently in its early phase. My view is that, ultimately, everything is going to be on one or more apps.

There is a huge explosion waiting to happen in the app world, especially in the Indian market. Uber, Haptik, Paytm and Flipkart have just shown us the power of apps. There is much more to come.

Apps will play a key role in connecting all the dots, so that all of us live in a connected way. Right from connected healthcare to smart cities, apps can improve the quality of life not just in urban regions but also in major parts of rural India. App developers are likely to bring about innovations such as predictable farming, smart education for rural children and care for the rural elderly in the near future. All in all, apps are going to be the only media that you will carry in your pocket, 24x7. I think this could happen within the next two years. **END**

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